

back into her clothes after having her baby, but who actually weighs less than she did before pregnancy. However, this is concerning for health professionals, since a dramatic weight loss after the birth is not good for mother or baby.

The recommended weight gain during pregnancy is 25–35 lb, have a BMI (see p.16) within the normal range. Your baby and her support system will make up a good proportion of this, as will the increased pregnancy fluids, fats, and an enlarged uterus (see [Components of weight gain](#)). Be reassured that much of this extra weight will be lost as soon as your baby is born. Also, after the birth, some of this extra weight provides nutrients for breast-feeding, which uses up to 500 calories a day.

The most sensible approach to controlling your weight during pregnancy is to eat a healthy diet and get gentle exercise to ensure that weight gain is not too dramatic. You only need additional calories in the last trimester of pregnancy. Aim for an additional 200 calories a day, which is the equivalent of a banana and a glass of milk.

Newborns are getting heavier mostly due to improved diet and living standards. However, obesity in the mother is another factor—if the mother is overweight, there is an increased risk of [diabetes](#), which can increase the baby's weight.